

ENG 101

Lesson - 31

A well written paragraph has 5 elements

- (i) a topic sentence
- (ii) supporting sentences
- (iii) a concluding sentence
- (iv) unity
- (v) coherence

The topic sentence is

(a) a complete sentence - it contains a subject, a verb and a complement (which is a word or words used to complete the meaning of a verb). (b) A topic sentence contains a topic as well as a controlling idea. I.e. first it names the topic and then it limits the topic to a specific area that is to be discussed in the paragraph.e.g.

-Driving on the motor way requires skill and agility

- *Platinum, a precious metal is used for two purposes.*

I) My study table is well organized. I keep ball point pens and colored pencils in the top right drawer. Writing paper is in the middle right drawer. The bottom right side has all the other material I might need, from paper clips to staples and tapes. The top of the desk is clear, except for a study lamp and a monthly planner. The left side of the desk has two drawers. The bottom one is a file drawer, where I keep my lecture notes from each class. And in the top drawer? That's where I keep peanuts, raisins, chocolates and chewing gum that I snack on while I study.

2) Do you have problems with sleeping? By following a few single guidelines many sleep problems can be avoided. First, don't drink tea or coffee close to bedtime. Next, do not exercise at least three hours before bedtime. Lastly, work out a sleep routine. Try to go to bed at the same time and try to get up at the same

(3) Today world-wide communications are taken for granted. Through telephone, TV and the inter-net, we learn instantly what happens all over the world. In ancient times, however, military leaders relied on a much slower, less technical method of sending important messages - pigeons. Homing pigeons are trained to return home from long distances. The birds were kept in cages at the military camps. When a message had to be sent, it was tied to the bird's leg. The bird was then released and it flew back to its base camp after delivering the message.

Probably in the coming decade there will be more use of home computers. People will use them to shop, to cast votes, file taxes, and to take college and university exams. Also, they will be used for playing games. Experts say the work week will be reduced to less than thirty-two hours. Moreover, robots will not only take over many routine service job but many dangerous jobs as well. As these forecasts suggest, the coming decade is likely to be a decade of home computers.

Review 1 To find out what you've learned so far answer each of the following questions. Fill in the blank or put a tick mark against the answer you think is correct.

1. The topic sentence of a paragraph states the (a) supporting details
(b) introducing material
(c) main idea
2. To find the topic sentence of a paragraph, look for a general statement. True or False?
3. The supporting details of a paragraph are more general than the main idea. True or False?
4. The topic sentence may appear in a paragraph (a) only once (b) more than once?

5. When the main idea is stated in the last sentence of a paragraph, it is likely to be

(a) a summary

(b) a conclusion

(c) either a or b Now we shall turn to the parts of a topic sentence. A topic sentence has two essential parts - the topic and the controlling idea. The topic (names) the subject or main idea of the paragraph.

- Driving in Lahore requires skill and nerves of steel.

- Living in an English speaking country improves the English of a foreign student.

- Sri Lanka is famous for its tea gardens.

- Television commercials are misleading.

Practice Writing Topic Sentences Write a topic sentence for each of the following topics include both a topic and controlling idea)

1. The effect of TV on children

2. Books on travel / Travel Books

3. Gardens

4. Popular Entertainment (general subject)

5. The Benefits of Foreign Travel

The Concluding Sentence: A concluding sentence has two purposes (i) it signals the end of the paragraph for this you should use words like in conclusion, in summary or finally.

(ii) It gives a final comment on your topic.

The following examples illustrate two different types of concluding sentences

I) Most people think of 'synonyms' as words 'having the same meaning', but it is easy to show that synonyms are always partial, never complete.

II) II). 'Tall' and 'high' are usually considered synonyms but while we can have both a tall building and 'a high building' we cannot have both 'a tall boy' and 'a high boy'. *Therefore, we should be careful in choosing words because many words that we considered turn out not to be really synonyms* (repeats main idea of topic sent)

(ii) Some people delight in inflicting pain on harmless little creatures. Such as flies, worms and frogs. They also take pleasure in killing them. This is very cruel of them. They ought not to do so, because it is wrong to cause unnecessary pain to any creature.

Besides, from being cruel to little animals, men are often led, to become cruel to their fellow creatures, and they learn to do very cruel deeds. *Whenever a man is tempted to hurt or kill any such creature he should pause to think how he would feel if any creature more powerful than he, were to do the same to him.* (concluding sentence summarizes the main 2 points not specifically stated in the topic sentence.)

Paragraph 1:

The scientist is more interested in doing scientific work than in defining it. He sometimes says that a piece of work or book is unscientific, and what he actually means by that phrase is that it is inexact, that it is badly arranged; that it jumps to conclusions without sufficient evidence, or that the author has allowed his personal prejudices to influence his report.....

Paragraph 2:

The habit of economy can easily be formed if we have a will to save. The first important thing in the formation of this habit, as in the case of many others, is to make a beginning. It does not matter with what sum we begin. We should make use of the first opportunity to make a beginning, secondly we should keep this habit alive by consistent effort. All this is possible only by a strong will-power. If once we decide to save, we should start immediately.....

Paragraph 3:

There are numerous everyday words in English that have come from other languages. English speakers relaxing at home, for example may put on *pajama*'s which is a Persian word. A sleep in the afternoon is called a '*siesta*' a Spanish word. When we wash our hair we '*shampoo*' it - from the South Indian word champi.

Writing Practice Home Work.

Choose a topic from the list below and write a paragraph 4-5 sentences in length.

Step I : Begin para w.good topic sentence.

II : Write general supporting sentences that explain or support the topic sentence.

III : Write a good concluding sentence.

Topics

1. Arranged Marriages
2. Population Explosion in Pakistan
3. Computers

Your instructor will give you a time limit, suggested limits:

Writing time = 13 minutes

Checking time = 02 minutes

Total = 15 minutes